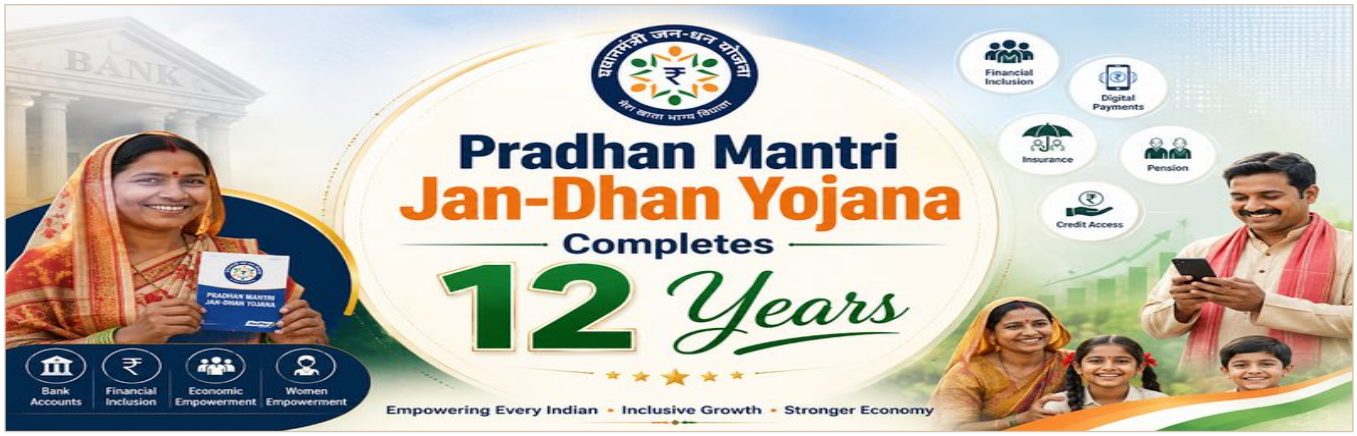


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[GS III - ECONOMY] | **Publication Date: 31/08/2026**

Pradhan Mantri Jan-Dhan Yojana Completes 12 Years



> *PMJDY has transformed financial inclusion by expanding banking access, strengthening women and rural empowerment, enabling digital payments, and supporting direct benefit transfers for greater economic self-reliance.*

Pradhan Mantri Jan-Dhan Yojana Completes 12 Years

Syllabus Areas:

GS III - Economy

The **Pradhan Mantri Jan-Dhan Yojana (PMJDY)** has completed **12 years**, marking a significant journey in India's efforts towards financial inclusion.

Union Minister for Women and Child Development **Smt. Annpurna Devi** described the scheme's journey as one that has moved **"from financial inclusion to economic empowerment."**

What is PMJDY?

Pradhan Mantri Jan-Dhan Yojana (PMJDY) was launched on 28 August 2014 by the Government of India. Pradhan Mantri Jan-Dhan Yojana is a financial inclusion initiative of the Government of India aimed at providing access to formal banking and financial services, particularly to underserved sections of society, thereby promoting financial security, inclusive growth and economic empowerment.



More than 59 crore Jan-Dhan accounts opened

A major achievement highlighted in the press release is the opening of **more than 59 crore Jan-Dhan accounts**.

These accounts have connected millions of citizens with the formal banking system and have contributed to building a foundation for greater financial self-reliance.

Women are major beneficiaries

Women account holders constitute a substantial share of the Jan-Dhan accounts.

- **56% of Jan-Dhan accounts belong to women.**

This highlights the important role of PMJDY in bringing women into the formal financial system and strengthening their access to banking services.

Strong rural and small-town penetration

The scheme has also achieved significant outreach beyond major urban centres.

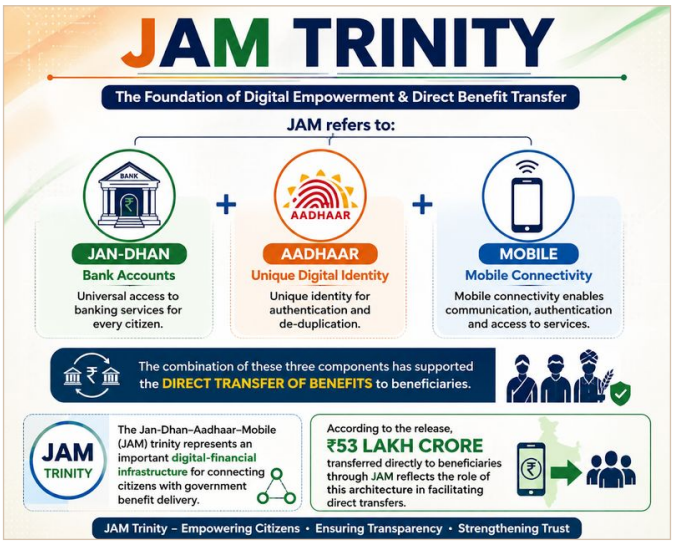
- **78% of Jan-Dhan accounts are in villages and small towns.**

This demonstrates the scheme's focus on extending formal banking access to rural populations and people living in smaller settlements.

Deposits cross Rs. 3.1 lakh crore

The deposits held in Jan-Dhan accounts have crossed **Rs. 3.1 lakh crore**.

This indicates the growing participation of account holders in the formal banking ecosystem and reflects the scale of financial resources brought into formal accounts through the scheme.



Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT)

Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) is a Government of India mechanism through which government subsidies, welfare benefits, and financial assistance are transferred directly into beneficiaries' bank accounts, reducing intermediaries and leakages.

Example: A farmer eligible for a government income-support scheme receives the money directly in their bank account rather than through a middleman.

Focus on women and rural families

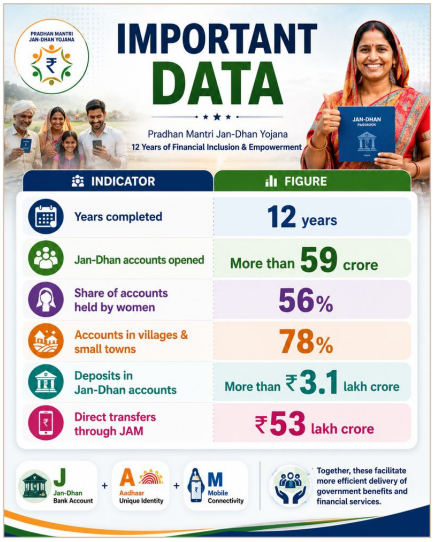
The Union Minister specifically highlighted the role of PMJDY in connecting **citizens, particularly women and rural families**, with the formal banking system.

The broader significance is therefore not merely the creation of bank accounts, but the expansion of access to formal financial services among sections of the population that have traditionally faced greater barriers to banking access.

Financial inclusion as a foundation for dignity and security

The press release characterises the Jan-Dhan journey as more than simply opening bank accounts. It describes the scheme as a **transformative journey of dignity, security and empowerment**.

It presents financial inclusion as an instrument that can strengthen people's economic participation and financial security.



From financial inclusion to economic empowerment

The central theme of the article is the evolution of PMJDY from a programme aimed at **financial inclusion** towards a broader foundation for **economic empowerment**.

The Minister described the initiative as having laid a strong foundation for **financial self-reliance**, particularly among women and rural families.

The key message can be understood through three stages:

Financial Inclusion !’ Financial Access !’ Economic Empowerment

Also Read Challenges and Way Forward